

The Steward's House

Home-repair judgment · ages 10–adult, families · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 · THE HOOK (3 min)

“Last year, what did your household pay someone else to fix? What did the visit cost — and what did the PART cost?” (Let the gap sink in.)

2 · PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

Run two full emergencies (the Tripping Breaker, then the Running Toilet). The group votes BEFORE each decision; when a dangerous choice tempts the room, let them pick it — the reset explanation teaches better than warning them off.

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 · THE TALK (8 min)

1. Which choice surprised you most, and why did the safe-looking option turn out dangerous?
2. Where is the line between “I can fix this” and “call a professional” — and who taught you yours?
3. What is one thing in THIS building nobody in the room knows how to shut off?

4 · SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Each learner runs the Gas Smell scenario alone — it is the one every human must get right.

5 · THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“Diagnose before paying, safety before speed.”

Homework: Tonight, find your home’s main water shut-off and show one other person where it is.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.